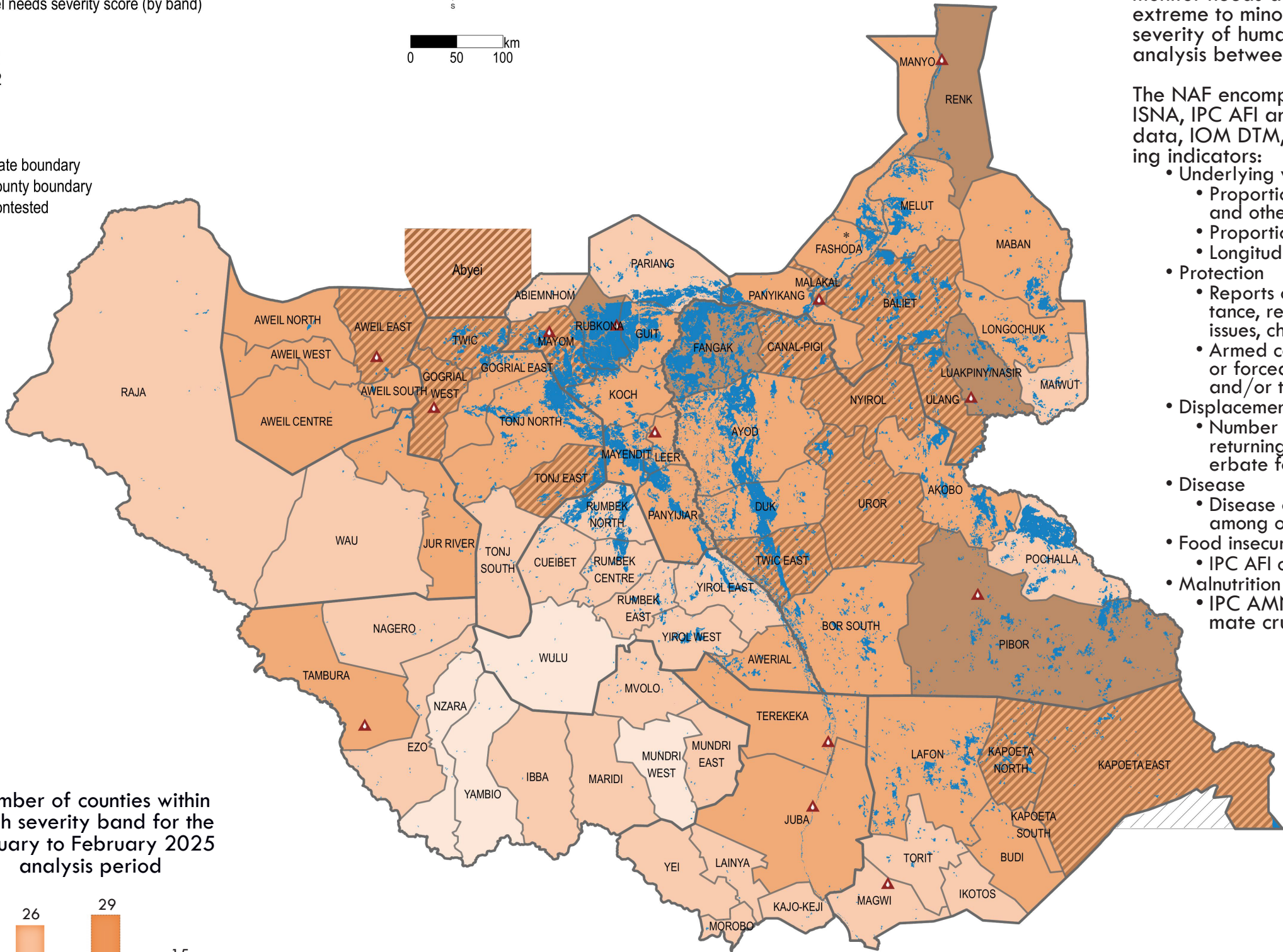
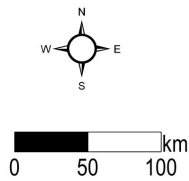
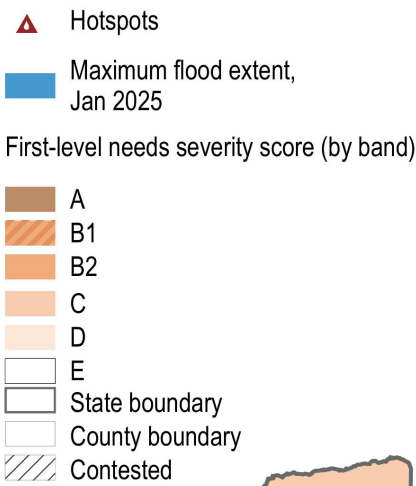


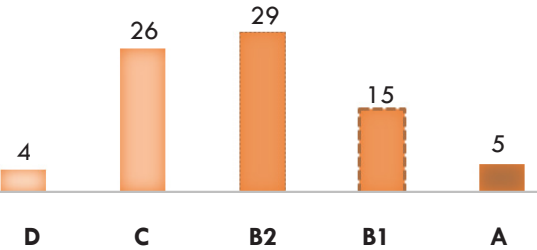
SOUTH SUDAN - NEEDS ANALYSIS WORKING GROUP (NAWG)

January 2025 - February 2025 Analysis

COUNTIES BY SCORE



Number of counties within each severity band for the January to February 2025 analysis period



For more information on the Needs Analysis Working Group or the NAWG Analytical Framework, please contact Felix Omuu (omuu@un.org) or Rebecca Hetzer (rebecca.hetzer@impact-initiatives.org).

Background

The NAWG meeting was held on March 4th, 2025 to discuss the analysis from the January to February period.

The objective of the NAWG is to conduct evidence-based and contextualized analysis of essential needs across South Sudan to inform decision-making and prioritization. To enable this, the NAWG analytical framework (NAF) was developed. The NAF provides a systematic approach to interpret a wide array of multi-sectoral information and monitor needs at the county-level. The final classification (ranging from extreme to minor humanitarian needs) is an intersectoral measure of the severity of humanitarian conditions in a county, allowing for comparative analysis between counties and across time.

The NAF encompasses data from a variety of sources (including FSNMS, ISNA, IPC AFI and AMN, SMART surveys, JMMI, ACLED, IRNAs, REACH data, IOM DTM, WHO IDSR, data from Clusters) which inform the following indicators:

- Underlying vulnerability
 - Proportion of female-headed households, child-headed households and other vulnerable-group headed households
 - Proportion of IDPs and/or returnees compared to host communities
 - Longitudinal food insecurity
- Protection
 - Reports of explosive hazards, lack of access to humanitarian assistance, restriction of movement, sexual violence, family separation, HLP issues, child labour, civil documentation issues, among others
 - Armed conflict events and/or conflict-related sexual violence and/or forced recruitment of children and/or targeted killings of civilians and/or targeted property destruction
- Displacement
 - Number of displaced persons arriving and/or number of returnees returning, as significant numbers of arrivals has the potential to exacerbate food and resource access
- Disease
 - Disease outbreaks, including cholera, measles, meningitis, and malaria, among others
- Food insecurity
 - IPC AFI classifications are used for each county
- Malnutrition
 - IPC AMN classifications or SMART survey data are used to estimate crude mortality

Needs severity levels

Severity band	Indicator threshold	Severity level definitions
A	8 - 10	Extreme humanitarian conditions
B1	7 - 7.9	Severe humanitarian conditions (higher severity)
B2	6 - 6.9	Severe humanitarian conditions (lower severity)
C	4 - 5.9	Moderate humanitarian conditions
D	2 - 3.9	Stressed humanitarian conditions
E	0 - 1.9	Minor or acceptable humanitarian conditions

SOUTH SUDAN - NEEDS ANALYSIS WORKING GROUP (NAWG)

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Counties facing “extreme” humanitarian conditions

Based on the backend analysis, three counties were initially classified as ‘Band A’, namely: **Pibor, Renk, and Nasir.**

Following in-depth discussion and contextual analysis during the NAWG meeting, **Fangak** and **Rubkona** were ultimately classified as exhibiting extreme humanitarian needs (Band A).

Discussion and joint analysis

- **Fangak:** Flagged due to the arrival of IDPs from Malakal over the second half of February. An aid agency on the ground confirmed the arrival of roughly 700 people from Malakal to Old Fangak between 22 - 24 of February, though the full extent of population movement has not been reported. Flooding in 2024 (and since 2019) has resulted in the crowding of people into small parcels of highland; traditional livelihoods remain inviable for most of the population, which is highly dependent on humanitarian assistance. The ongoing cholera outbreak is also of concern. Current figures indicate 793 cholera cases and 27 deaths in Fangak, with Hepatitis E also being a persistent health concern. **Final classification: Elevated from Band B1 to Band A**
- **Rubkona:** Flagged due to the critical and imminent collapse of healthcare services following funding cuts. The closure of 8 health facilities as of March 3rd, will reportedly likely affect over 200,000 IDPs. It was also highlighted that the management of a major NGO-supported hospital in being transitioned to the state authorities, potentially leading to service disruptions or changes in continuity. Acute malnutrition and acute food insecurity remain severe and widespread. **Final classification: Elevated from Band B1 to Band A**
- **Kapoeta East:** Reported displacement from Jie Payam in Kapoeta East to Karkomuge in Kapoeta North and other areas of Kapoeta East due to water scarcity. Media reports of four thirst-related deaths; unconfirmed by aid organizations. Escalating insecurity along the border with Greater Pibor Administrative Area, driven by Toposa-Murle tensions, is further hindering fulfillment of basic needs. Tensions have escalated over the past year, leading to numerous deaths, displacement, and ongoing closure of the Kapoeta-Boma road, a crucial supply route for communities in highlands (Eastern) Pibor. **Final classification: Elevated from Band B2 to Band B1**
- **Magwi:** Flagged due to recent attacks and fighting related to presence of cattle keepers from Jonglei. It was reported that displaced populations are yet to return

to their homes and remain in Magwi town, indicating a continued need for support. Although Magwi is currently in IPC Phase 2, according to analysis conducted in October 2024, it is likely that cultivation has been disrupted by the recent insecurity, and as such, may ultimately reach a more severe phase than anticipated by the IPC. As a result, a NAWG member recommended the county to be placed on “close monitoring”. It was mentioned that NFI kits have been distributed to some IDPs, and some returns are beginning. Partners in Torit are planning assessments in return areas. **Final classification remains at Band C, to be added to close monitoring.**

Counties Flagged for Close Monitoring

The following counties have been flagged for close monitoring to encourage partners to gather more information and closely track the evolving situation. **Partners are requested to pay close attention to these counties and share any relevant information.**

- **Pibor:** The situation in Pibor was flagged as alarming, including in the East (highlands) of the county which has been facing challenges since last year due to growing tensions with communities from Eastern Equatoria and associated road closures since April 2024. Response prioritization has in recent years focused on the West. The East was deprioritized for HFA in 2022. In the West (in Gumuruk) recent attacks indicate a likely deterioration in the humanitarian situation, and a need for close monitoring. It was noted that Pibor is already classified as Band A and HRP Priority 1 county. **Final classification: Band A**
- **Renk:** Renk remains under close monitoring due to increasing displacement and movement from Sudan, adding pressure on already strained resources in the area. **Final classification: Band A**
- **Malakal:** Malakal is flagged for continued close monitoring due to concerning projections of pockets of IPC Phase 5 (Catastrophe) food insecurity anticipated between April and July 2025. Two recent SMART surveys indicate very high levels of needs evidenced by extremely severe acute food insecurity and critical rates of acute malnutrition. Additionally, the high incidence of cholera cases reported in schools within Malakal raises ongoing public health concerns that warrant close attention. **Final classification: Band B1**
- **Baliet, Nasir, Nyirol, Ulang:** These counties are flagged due to ongoing fighting along the Sobat River corridor, including reports of airstrikes. Widespread reports of displaced civilians from Nasir Town to surrounding payams and across the border to Ethiopia. There is a high likelihood of further clashes. Nyirol is particularly affected by a cholera outbreak, necessitating close monitoring

specifically for Chuil Payam within Nyirol. Baliet and Ulang were both elevated from B2 to B1 severity bands. **Final classifications: Baliet (Band B1), Nasir (Band A), Nyirol (Band B1), Ulang (Band B1).**

- **Ezo, Nagero, Tambura, Yambio:** These Western Equatoria counties are flagged for close monitoring due to heightened tensions and instability following the recent dismissal of the state governor. While allegations of violence against the Balanda community require corroboration, Ezo and Nagero are of particular concern due to reports of armed group activities removing roadblocks leading to fighting and displacement. **Final classifications: Ezo (Band C), Nagero (Band C), Tambura (B2), Yambio (D).**
- **Uror:** Flagged for close monitoring due to worrying IPC projections indicating a 5% likelihood of Phase 5 (Catastrophe) food insecurity between April and July 2025. While planned humanitarian assistance is factored into these projections, any delays or disruptions in aid delivery could trigger a rapid deterioration of the food security situation. **Final classification: Band B1**
- **Gogrial West:** Flagged for close monitoring due to media reports of exhausted medical supplies in health facilities since December, limiting access to free health services. It was also flagged due to a disparity between its HRP priority rank (3) and NAWG backend analysis (B1). **Final classification: Band B1**
- **Kapoeta North:** Flagged due to an estimated influx of 8,000 individuals seeking refuge, putting pressure on local resources. **Final classification elevated from Band B2 to Band B1.**
- **Lainya:** Flagged due to reports of cattle herders occupying farmland and causing significant crop destruction. This land-use conflict threatens agricultural production and could heighten food insecurity if unaddressed. Lainya remains under close monitoring. **Final classification: Band C.**
- **Jur River:** Flagged due to reports of clashes between government and opposition forces in February. Additionally, there have been reports of protection concerns, including allegations of human rights violations such as torture, arbitrary detention, and sexual violence. Reports also indicate that a local market was burned and civilian property looted. Moreover, a cholera outbreak is ongoing, with 28 suspected cases and 3 reported deaths as of February 21st. **Final classification is elevated from Band C to Band B2.**